

Yet another MS OS

Microsoft launched their latest mobile OS — Windows Mobile 6.5 on the 17th of February.

More cut calls?

The number of mobile phones used in India is over 36,22,00,000.

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have digital zoom instead of optical zoom. An actual moving lens could help make the leap. Another great divide that cell phones need to cross is sensor size. For greater picture density sensor size in phones must be increased.

Better looking phones

There are the standard chocolate bar phones, sliding phones, and flip phones but we really could do with some radical designs. Something interesting we laid eyes on recently was the GD900; LG's transparent phone. Its got a glass-like polished silver body and a translucent keypad. A light illuminates around its

keypad to make the buttons visible. It'll definitely come in handy if you're Hollow Man or the Invisible woman from fantastic four!

Accessories compatibility (3.5-mm audio jacks and memory cards)

Compatibility is one of the most important factors when it comes to cell phones and its associated accessories. For instance one should be able to plug in any pair of headphones or earphones into any phone. If each manufacturer has its own proprietary standard, so much of listening equipment is rendered useless. One of the possible reasons why cell phone manu-

facturers even have their own distinct standards could be additional revenue. For example if your bundled LG or Sony Ericsson earphones get ruined, you have no other option than to go in for replacements from that manufacturer. Also most discerning audio fanatics will agree that earphones that come along with most phones are not up to the mark in terms of audio quality. Naturally you would want to use your high quality headphones, but often the jack on your cell phone will not be a 3.5-mm standard jack. For phones to truly replace portable MP3 players they must allow listeners to be able to choose which headphone they want to plug into their device. Another issue is with expandable memory. When changing phones it should be as simple as transferring the memory card from one phone to the other. This doesn't always happen because of so many proprietary formats such as M2, SD/MMC, Memory Stick, xD-Picture Card etc.

Other wishes

When you buy a rather pricey device, it is not unfair to expect the phone to be easy to handle and of a better build quality. Better ergonomics would surely help; like scalloped or bevelled keys, angled screens etc. Plus the slider quality in most sliding phones leaves a lot to be desired. Since we're in the era of touch screens, that's an area that could use some R&D, especially by companies other than Apple. Functionality could be improved with small measures like having more useful displays in standby mode — giving you more at a glance without having to open the phone or unlock or slide. We would also like some more ease with inter-transferability of personal data such as contacts, notes and calendar entries between brands.

So we hope our little wish list finds its way into the R&D lab of some handset manufacture. And if at all some genie manufacturer decides to make our wish his command, we get first dibbs on the dream device!

Local search

What do you normally do when you are looking for a service or product in the non virtual world? A few years ago you would thumb through a dusty old yellow pages directory. Then we got pretty comfortable with services such as Just Dial. Now, it looks like the search giant of the virtual world Google, intends to enter the local search fray in a big way. Recently, Mumbai and Bangalore got a taste of Google's phone search. Initially launched in Hyderabad and Delhi about a year ago,

